Do visual-selection operations measure technical quality?

Sixteen operations plus the deployed score, a 19-extractor ablation, and end-to-end segment substitution

Redundancy cluster

Band 0:00–1:34

J. Nacional 0:00–0:51

Record 0:31–0:49

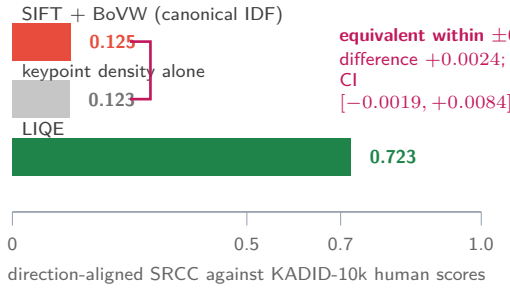
`catedral_notre_dame`
deployed keeps Record; an eligible model keeps J. Nacional

Scoring operation

In use: SIFT → BoVW → TF-IDF sum
designed for retrieval and categorization, not for quality

Eligible: LIQE, QualiCLIP, CLIP-IQA+
three complete-case methods clear the operational screen

Controlled-distortion database



equivalent within ± 0.02
difference $+0.0024$; block CI
$[-0.0019, +0.0084]$

Take-away

The class. Thirteen of fifteen heuristics prefer the degraded copy under white noise; none is eligible.

The mechanism. The deployed score is $D \cdot \overline{\mathrm{idf}}$, and count alone carries the sign in 797 of the 800 pairs.

The consequence. An eligible model changes 22 of 42 selected segments, under the stated rule and not as a ranking.

Five evidence blocks

1 What the sources state → **2** Constructed truth, 800 pairs → **3** Mechanism of the deployed case → **4** Human scores on 3 databases → **5** Effect on the selections made